

Returning to Germany, Ilgner organized a "Circle of Economic Advisors" whose principal purpose was to influence the Propoganda Ministry to be more moderate. Goebbels joined the Circle along with Funk, who was then Goebbel's State Secretary. <sup>R</sup> "I told the Circle what the world was thinking and I didn't paint a rosy picture as was customary in the Third Reich. We were worried about German exports. We were tried and proven foreign economists and we knew well the reaction of the world to propoganda. I knew that propoganda means something else in America than it does in Germany. We objected even against the name, 'Propoganda Ministry.' This is an old story that is buried and forgotten; but if I remember correctly, the Circle met two or three occasions with the chairmanship of Goebbels, and just as often under Fuhk's chairmanship. But Goebbels wasn't stupid. He was vexed."

The thing that vexed Goebbels most was that Dr. Ilgner had a restless, impetuous interest in everything in the world - - and Ilgner became the leading spirit of the Circle. The Rotary Club, like the Free Masons, was international poison to Goebbels, and Ilgner kept arguing with him not to go through with his announced intention of dissolving Rotary in Germany. Ilgner also openly protested in the Circle that Germany should not ~~leave~~ have withdrawn from the League of Nations. He had conceived of the Circle as a sort of adult-study group of businessmen who took the world to be their oyster and would advise the Government how it might be seasoned happily for all concerned. ~~And~~ despite Goebbels, Ilgner went ahead.

"Mr. Diehn knew East Asia; he took over that part of the world. Mr. Rupert treated